

WEBSITE PROPOSAL: REVIVE THRIFT CO.

Module: WEB DEVELOPMENT (WEDE5020)

Full Name: Lesedi Tsutsubi

Student Number: ST10519854

GROUP: 2



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ORGINASATION OVERVIEW: Revive Thrift Co.

Revive Thrift Co. is a newly established second-hand and vintage clothing store opening in Braamfontein, Johannesburg a student-heavy, fashion-conscious area that previously hosted a well-loved thrift store before it closed permanently. Revive Thrift Co., was founded to fill that gap, offering affordable, quality preloved fashion to students and young professionals. Our mission is to make sustainable, individual style accessible and affordable; our vision is to become Braamfontein's go-to destination for unique, budget-friendly fashion. The target audience is students and young professionals aged 18 to 35 who want individuality without the cost of retail fashion.

Website Goals and Objectives:

- Build brand awareness for our new business entering a familiar retail space.
- Drive both foot traffic to the physical store and interest in an online catalogue.
- Grow a loyal customer community around sustainable, affordable fashion.
- KPIs: website visits that convert to store visits, catalogue enquiries, social media follower growth.

Current Website Analysis:

As a new business, Revive Thrift Co. has no existing website, which is itself a strength: the site can be built from scratch with modern UX rather than retrofitted. The gap it responds to is the previous nearby thrift store's reliance solely on Facebook, which led to outdated information and no browsable catalogue. Revive Thrift Co.'s website will avoid these gaps from the outset, but also major changes made to the whole website and a different user interface implemented with the same color gradients but a totally different look.

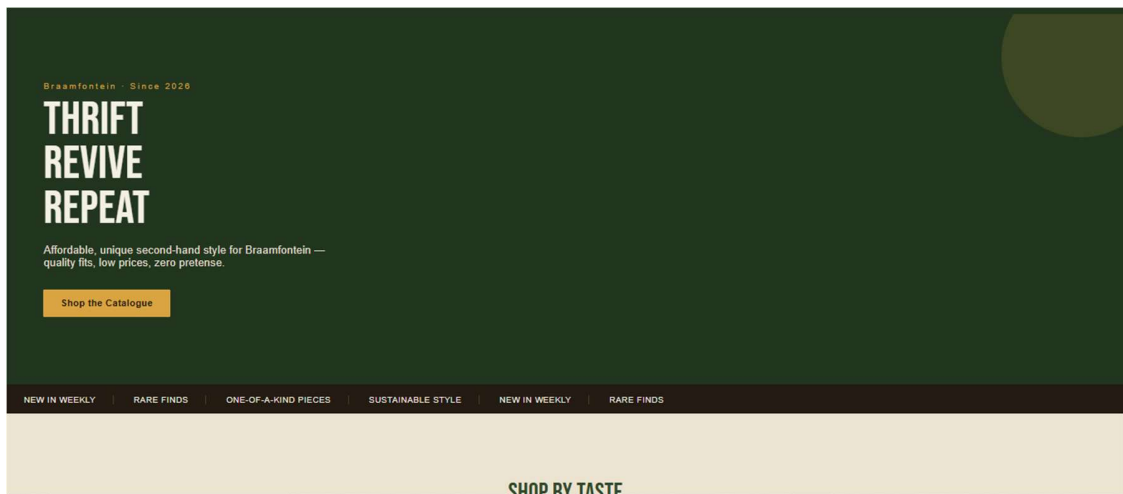
Proposed Website Features and Functionality

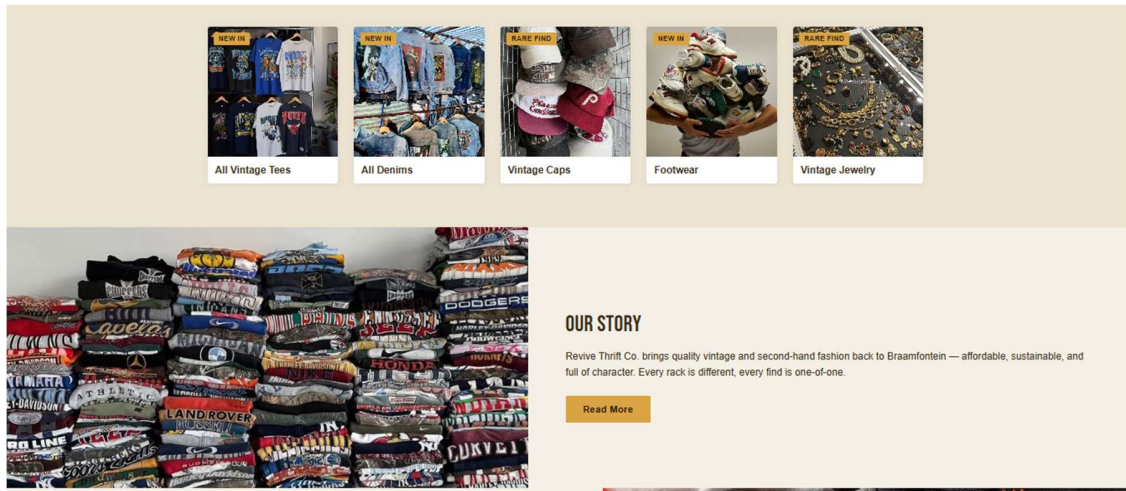
- Homepage introduces the store and includes a brief story but for additional information users can click about button at the navigation bar.
- Shop/Catalogue page browsable by category (All vintage tees, All Denim, Vintage caps, Footgear, and Vintage Jewelry.).
- Location & Hours page with an embedded map.
- Instagram feed integration to showcase new stock.
- Contact page with WhatsApp and email options.
- And “NEW IN” tags on the clothing category to show any new items or pieces that have been sourced out.
- Also, a cool function that was added when the user clicks the logo the website goes home instantly.

Design and User Experience:

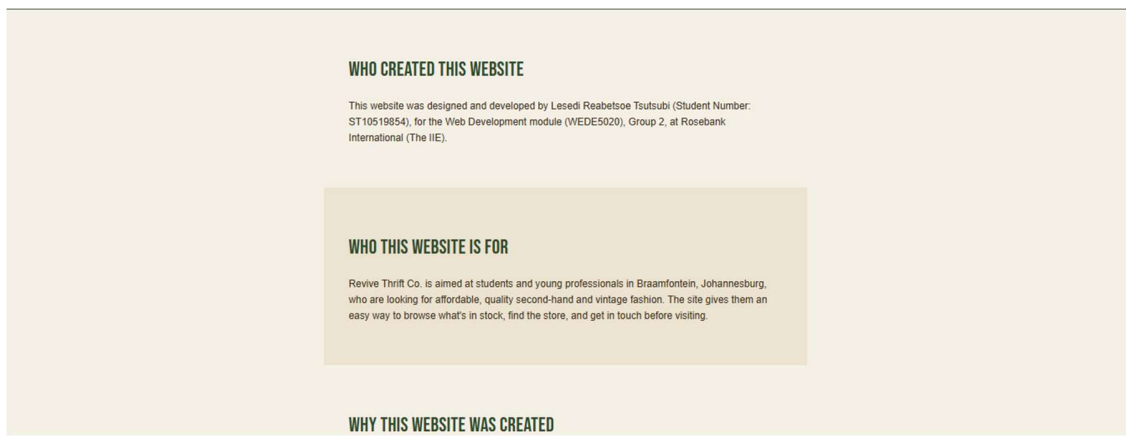
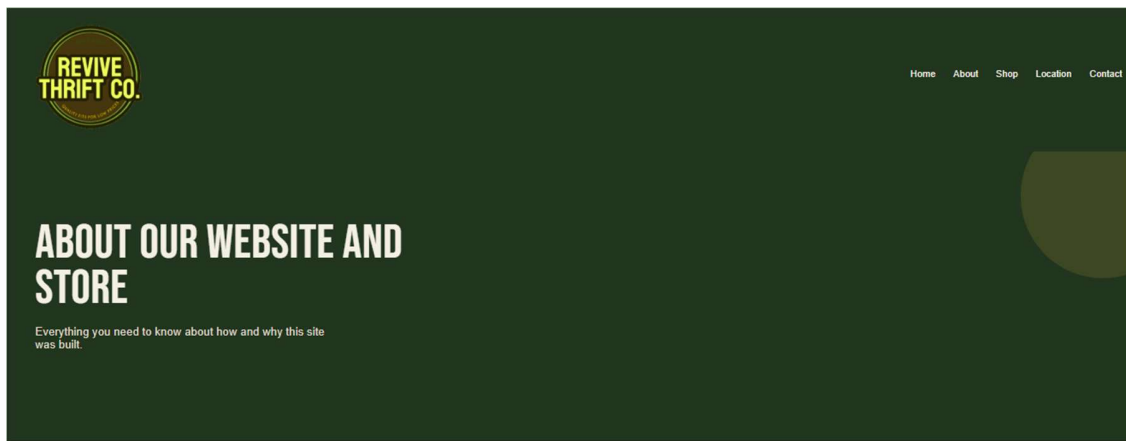
- Color Scheme: earthy tones — mustard, forest green, and cream — to evoke vintage warmth, this will bring about a vintage classic theme.
- Typography: a retro-inspired display font for headings, paired with a clean sans-serif for body text.
- Layout and Design: grid-based catalogue layout with large, clear product images.
- User experience considerations: simple filtering and a mobile friendly layout, since most shoppers browse via phone.

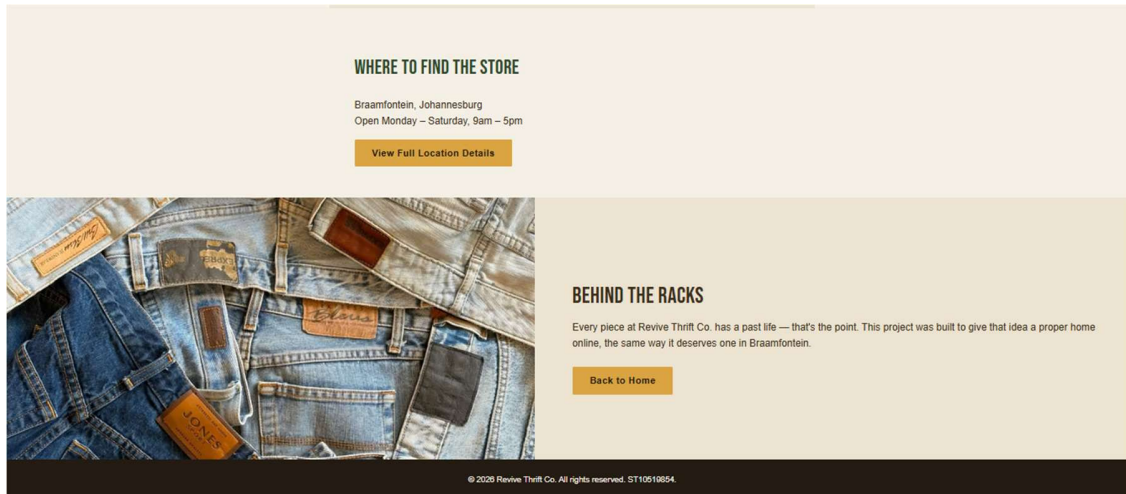
The homepage has been built to reflect this design direction, shown below:



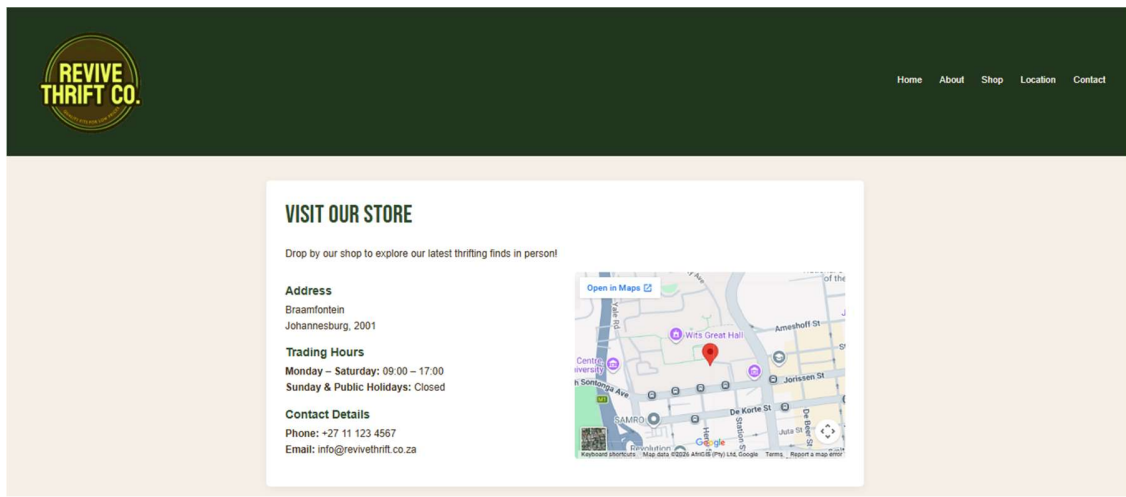


The about page:

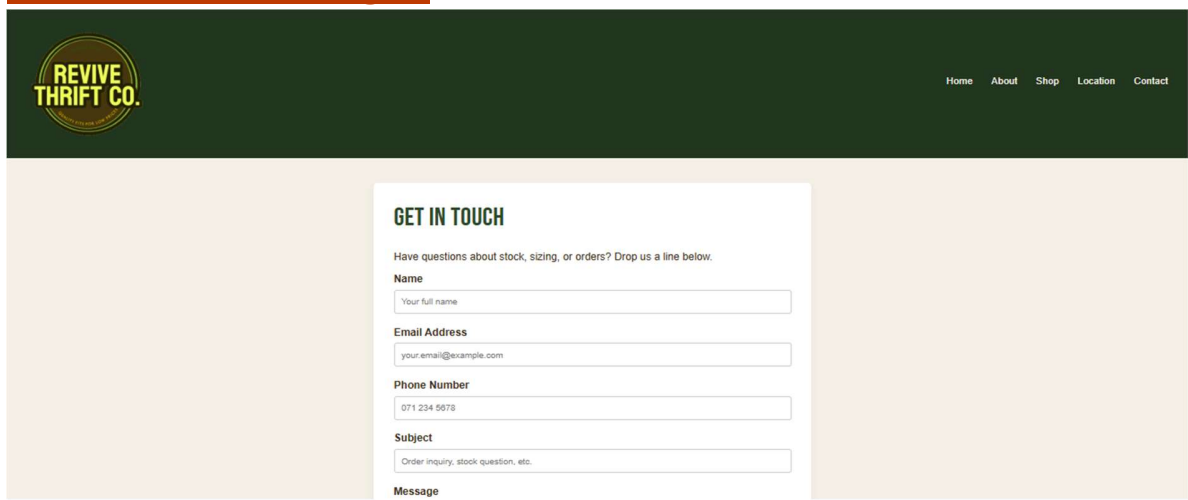




The location page:



The Contact page:



Technical Requirements:

- A .co.za domain (e.g. revivethrift.co.za) hosted through a provider such as Namecheap.
- The site will be built using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- A code editor (preferably VS code or any code editor to the developers choosing).
- Must be tested on at least two browsers (Chrome + Microsoft Edge).
- Git + GitHub for version control, this lets developers track changes and is often expected for web development.
- Meta description tags per page
- Semantic HTML (header/nav/main/footer).
- Minified CSS/JS for submission for the website.

Timeline and Milestones:

- Weeks 1 till 2: Wireframes and design approval. Content and photo sourcing – gathering/editing photos, logo, and copy before layout works starts.
- Weeks 3 till 4: Development of core pages and catalogue. CSS styling and responsive design pass.
- Week 5: Testing across devices. Form integration and testing – setting up Form spree (or equivalent) and testing that submission arrive. Cross-browser and device – checking the site in at least two browsers and mobile/tablet/desktop widths. Accessibility check – alt text, color contrasts, keyboard and navigation.
- Week 6: Launch, aligned with the subject's submission dates. Deployment – publishing to GitHub Pages/Netlify and confirming all links/images work on the live URL, not just locally.
- Week 7: Deployment and final proofreading- – a pass for typos, broken links, and consistency before submission.

Budget:

- Domain registration (.co.za): R150/year.
- Logo design/refinement (if someone outsourced rather than DIY): R500 to R1500.
- Stock or product photography (if not using your own phone camera): R0 (DIY) or R1000 + (professional).

Recurring costs:

- Web hosting: - R900/year (or R0 if using GitHub Pages/Netlify's free tier)
- SSL certificate: usually bundled free with modern hosts (Netlify/GitHub Pages included this automatically) – worth naming explicitly since its real requirement, not just an add-on.
- Domain renewal: R150/year, recurring.

Tools and services:

- Form handling (Form spree free tier covers small volumes; paid tier - \$10/month if the store outgrows the free submission limit)
- Google Workspace or similar for a professional email address (info@revivethrift.co.za) instead of a personal email Gmail: - R100-R150/month per mailbox.

Ongoing maintenance:

- General site updates/content changes: -R400-R500/month (already in your draft-worth specifying what this covers: swapping product photos, updates stock, seasonal promotions).
- Minor bug fixes/technical support: build in a rough hourly rate or flat monthly allowance if this is meant to look like a real freelance/small-business quote.

Major Changes made to the website:

Structure and Pages:

- Re-structured pages: Home.html, About page.html, Contact page.html and Location page.html
- Fixed broken page navigation filename mismatches.
- Fixed the About page's empty navigation menu.
- Made the logo clickable back to Home page instantly, and visually responding when already on the homepage.
- Standardized image folder casing (Images/) across all pages so the links don't break on case-sensitive hosting.
- Fixed a trailing-space bug in an image path that would have broken the logo.

Styling:

- Converted the entire site from inline styles to one shared external style.css file.
- Added responsive breakpoints (768px/480px) also nav stacks, cards go full-width, buttons stack on mobile.
- Full visual redesign: bold, stacked headline hero (Bedas Neue font) in forest green/mustard, category ticker strip, tagged products cards ("New In"/" Rare Find").
- Added alternating image + text "split" sections (image left/right alternating) which is used for "Our Story," "Visit Us," and "Get in Touch" on the home page.
- Added a matching split section ("Behind the Racks") near the end of the About page.
- Increased logo size (60px to 130px).
- Removed the green background from the logo and made it transparent

Functionality:

- Added script.js with a working “Use My Location for Directions” button.
- We added a phone number to contact the Contact form (alongside name, email, subject, message).
- Added a two-photo gallery (“Find Us in Store”) to the Contact page.

References:

Revive Thrift Co. is a fictional business. Its design direction was loosely informed by general observation of Braamfontein's second-hand clothing retail scene, including Thrift Vintage Clothes, a since-closed local store, used here only as inspiration and not as a real-world subject of this proposal.